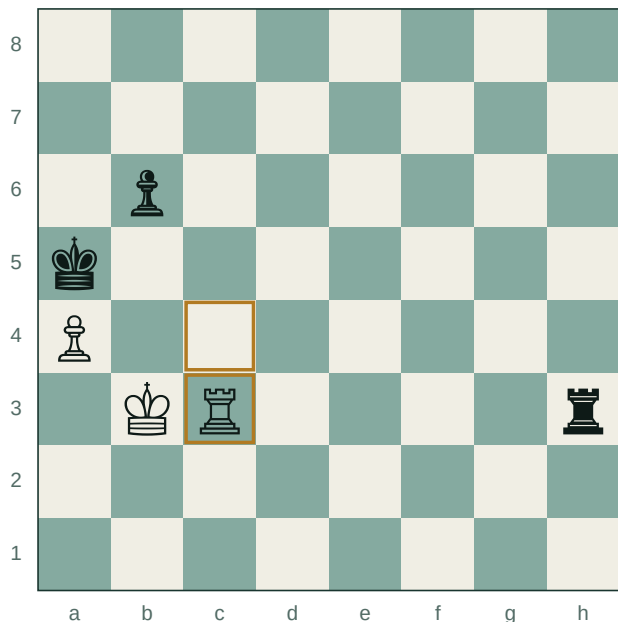


Active defensive resources: Black, move 64

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 64.Rc3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

64...Rxc3+ 65. Kxc3 Kxa4 66. Kb2 Kb4

64...Rxc3+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on c3. Recorded reply: **65.Kxc3**.

65...Kxa4 The king captures the pawn on a4. Recorded reply: **66.Kb2**.

66...Kb4 The king moves from a4 to b4.

At the end, nominal material is White 0 / Black 1 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on b3. Absolute pin: rook on c3.